

**The Sixth Regular Meeting of the  
Medford School Committee**

**Monday, December 6, 2021**

***Executive Session: 6:00 PM***

***Regular Meeting: 6:30 PM***

**To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.**

***Masks are required for in-person attendance.***

**Also presented on Zoom.**

**Join Zoom Meeting**

**<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/95929381965>**

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***Agenda***

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Negotiations and Legal Matters - Executive Session: 6:00PM

*Upon a Motion to enter into executive session pursuant to M. G.L. c. 30A §21(a) .*

The Medford School Committee will convene in Executive session pursuant to G.L. c. 30A §21(a) to hear a grievance being brought by the Medford Teachers Association. The Medford School Committee will reconvene in public session following the conclusion of the executive session.

- IV. Consent Agenda
  - Approval of Bills/Payrolls
  - Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 11.15.2021

V. Report of Subcommittees

1. Special Education Subcommittee Meeting Minutes, 11.18.2021 - *Melanie McLaughlin*

VI. Report of the Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. Briefing on student disciplinary policies and efforts related to school climate and culture - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Assistant Superintendents Dr. Peter Cushing and Suzanne Galusi
3. Early Literacy Report-Assistant Superintendent Suzanne Galusi, Dr. Nicole Chiesa, Ms. Suzannah Campbell, and Ms. Kathleen Ciampoli will provide an early literacy update on the alignment of the Science of Reading
4. Updated Presentation on Superintendent's Goals for SY2021-2022- Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

VII. Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

“Regular Meetings of the School Committee include this ‘Presentations of the Public’ agenda item to give any resident the opportunity to place a presentation before the School Committee. A resident may only present once at any meeting.

These presentations are an opportunity for the public to make a presentation to the Committee but are not opportunities for dialog with the Committee. If one or more members of the Committee wishes to have a conversation about the topic presented, a member may request that the item be added to a subsequent Regular Meeting.

The details for submitting a presentation can be found within the policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public”

“Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. Residents may also submit their comments by writing to the Superintendent of Schools prior to the meeting, or by emailing [medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us](mailto:medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us) prior to or during the item on the agenda. Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee.

A welcoming inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective.

When writing or emailing, please provide this required information: 1) The number and name of the item on the agenda. 2) Your first and last name. 3) Your full Medford street address where you reside. 4) Your question or comment”

VIII. Continued Business

IX. New Business

1. Whereas the health and safety of the children of Medford is of the utmost importance to the Medford School Committee, as is the well-being of children throughout the Commonwealth of Massachusetts;

Whereas many Massachusetts schools and child care centers permit the use of toxic pesticides on outdoor grounds, including glyphosate and 2,4-D, potentially endangering children’s health;

Whereas children absorb more pesticides relative to their body weight than adults, and children’s organ systems are still developing and are less able to detoxify harmful chemicals, and in 2012 the American Academy of Pediatrics (AAP) called for governments to reduce children’s exposure to pesticides, writing that scientific evidence “demonstrates associations between early life exposure to pesticides and pediatric cancers, decreased cognitive function, and behavioral problems.”;

Whereas a bill currently proposed at the Massachusetts State Legislature, H.926, “An Act relative to improving pesticide protections for Massachusetts schoolchildren”, would allow only pesticides considered minimum risk by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency and those permitted for organic use to be used near schools and child care centers in Massachusetts, except in the case of a health emergency when school officials could apply for a waiver, similar to laws passed by the State of New York in 2010 and by the State of Connecticut in 2015;

Whereas this bill, filed by Representative Carmen Gentile, is cosponsored by the entire Medford delegation, Representatives Paul Donato, Sean Garballey, and Christine Barber together with many other legislators; and

Whereas this bill is endorsed by a growing coalition of environmental, health and community advocacy organizations, including the Center for Biological Diversity, Climate Action Now Western Massachusetts, the Conservation Law Foundation, Massachusetts Forest Watch, the Massachusetts Sierra Club, MASSPIRG, Mothers Out Front Massachusetts, the Northeast Organic Farming Association, and the Sustainable Business Network of Massachusetts, now therefore, be it

Resolved, that the School Committee of Medford:

1) supports H.926, “An Act relative to improving pesticide protections for Massachusetts schoolchildren”;

2) urges the Massachusetts House of Representatives to bring this bill to a vote; and

3) sends a letter of support to the Honorable Speaker Mr. Mariano, the Honorable Mr. Donato, the Honorable Mr. Garballey, the Honorable Ms. Barber.

- *Offered by: Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau*

2. Given the substantial limitation of the use of out-of-school suspensions approved unanimously by the Medford School Committee on October 14, 2020; and given this change allowed for nearly a year of planning for implementation by district leadership: the Superintendent will present the plans that were developed in that year prior to this change, including how principals and assistant principals were trained on changes they have implemented at the start of this school year to comply with this change in policy; the number of detentions, Saturday detentions, in-school suspensions, and any out-of-school suspensions issued from the start of the 2021-2022 school year through October 31 disaggregated by school and grade level; professional development offered to any staff and the percentage of staff by type and school level that participated; challenges that are being worked through; recommendations the School Committee should consider to assist with implementation of the policy; and future plans for continuing this work to ensure all students have access to the education they have a right to under the Massachusetts Constitution.

- *Offered by: Paul Ruseau*

3. The Rules, Policy, and Equity Subcommittee will review the implementation of the October 2020 policy on the use of out-of-school suspensions in light of recent out-of-school suspensions that appear to fail to meet the spirit or intent of the policy passed unanimously by the Medford School Committee and will make recommendations if necessary to clarify the language of the policy.

- *Offered by: Paul Ruseau*

4. The Superintendent will schedule a tour for the Medford School Committee of all boys and girls locker rooms at Medford High School in the month of January. Furthermore, a complete listing of spending on boys and girls sports from all sources will be provided at the first meeting of the School Committee in February.

- *Offered by: Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau*

5. Whereas, the School Committee is committed to achieving the missions statement of Medford Public Schools: The Medford Public Schools is a caring educational partnership

of school, family, and community designed to ensure that all students are afforded a safe and healthy learning environment in which they develop the knowledge, skills, and attitudes to reach their full academic and personal potential and,

Whereas, the effects of the pandemic have exacerbated challenges in school climate and culture nationwide and here in Medford,

Therefore, be it resolved that the Medford Public Schools will issue an RFP to perform a Climate and Culture Assessment of Medford High School to be completed before the end of this academic year. The RFP will seek a qualified and independent vendor to conduct a survey of staff, students, and families who are part of the high school community.

Be it also resolved that the project scope will include recommendations to address moving forward in a manner that prioritizes a healthy school community and contends with the district's past handling of incidents that are race, gender, or bullying based.

Be it also resolved that recommendations will outline organizational, structural, professional development, and curriculum-based changes needed to address the findings and achieve our district-wide mission.

Be it further resolved that the School Committee authorizes an expenditure of up to \$50,000 to complete this important initiative and that the Superintendent will return to the School Committee to seek authorization for additional funds should the qualified bids received at the bid opening be in excess of this authorization.

- *Submitted by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau*

X. Reports Requested

XI. Condolences

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Beverly Ann Convery, wife of the late Thomas E. Convery, a History and Civics Teacher and Head of Job Placement at Medford High School.

XII. Next Meeting

- **Monday, December 20, 2021: Regular School Committee Meeting** - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom:  
<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99954546677>

XIII. Adjournment